UnityURP-Unlit ScreenSpaceDecal Shader(SRP batcher compatible)

Before adding decal

After adding decal

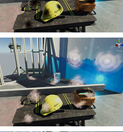
Before adding decal

After adding decal

Before adding decal (with "GameObject" using material of the shader, adding box)

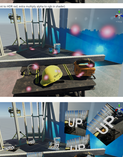
After adding decal (with box visible)

Before adding decal



After adding decal

Before adding decal (with URP Decal Projector)



After adding decal (with URP Decal Projector)

Before adding decal

After adding decal

Before adding decal

After adding decal

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Before adding decal

After adding decal

Before adding decal

After adding decal

When should I use this shader?

If you need to render bullet holes, dirt/rain on wall, 3D projected UI, explosion 2D/4D mark, blood splat, projected shadow, footprints, foliage interaction, ... and the receiver surface is not flat/can't use the transparent queue to finish the job, try using this shader.

How to use this shader in my project?

1. Clone the shader to your project
2. Make sure your project's pipeline is URP's setting (search UniversalRP-HighQuality in your project)
3. Press play, now enable depth texture in URP's setting (search UniversalRP-HighQuality in your project)
4. Press play, now enable depth texture in URP's setting (search UniversalRP-HighQuality in your project)
5. Press play, now enable depth texture in URP's setting (search UniversalRP-HighQuality in your project)

6. Create a new material using that shader (right click on the shader -> Create->Material)
7. assign any texture to material's Texture slot
8. Create a new GameObject (GameObject->Create) in scene (in Hierarchy window, click +/GO Object/Cube)
9. apply that material to the GameObject's MeshRenderer component's material slot (drag material on the Cube)
10. edit the GameObject's transform so the local forward vector (in blue Z arrow) is pointing to some objects, and the box is touching the objects
11. you should now see your new decal cube is rendering correct(projecting) without bending texture to some objects correctly!
12. Optional(Box Collider / MeshingObject), according to your needs
13. Optional(Finally, make the cube as Prefab)It will possibly to improve CPU rendering performance

Requirement when using this shader

- Forward rendering is on
- Unity URP pipeline(Universal RP) is already rendering by unity (toggle on Depth/texture in your Universal Render Pipeline Asset)
- For mobile, you need at least OpenGLES3/3.0 (Supports target 3.0 due to tex2dlod, & tex2D)

Edition System Requirements

- Unity 2019.1 or later (Due to "shader_feature_local"). But you can replace to "shader_feature" if you want to use this shader in older unity versions.

I can see decal in scene window, but not in game window

you must enable depth texture in URP's setting (search UniversalRP-HighQuality in your project
If it still doesn't work, try setting all setting renderer feature.

I can see decal in editor(both scene and game window), but not in mobile build

you must enable depth texture in URP's setting (search UniversalRP-HighQuality in your project
Also, if you are using Android device, you may need to enable "Vulkan" in your project. turn on depth texture.

My Game use orthographic camera, but the decal shader doesn't work

enable toggle "_SupportOrthographicCamera" in material

I can see decal renders correctly, but which Blend/Mode should I use in the material inspector?

Blend SrcAlpha OneMinusSrcAlpha // Traditional transparency

Blend One OneMinusSrcAlpha // Premultiplied transparency

Blend One One // Additive

Blend OneMinusDstColor One // Soft Additive

Blend DstColor Zero // Multiplicative

Blend DstColor SrcColor // 2x Multiplicative

https://docs.unity3d.com/Manual/SL-Blend.html

Is this shader optimized for mobile?

This screen space decal shader is URP batcher compatible, so you can put lots of decals in scene without hurting CPU performance too much(most of decals use different materials).

Also, this shader is using "shader_feature_local" in order to render shadow, so you can put lots of decals in scene without hurting CPU performance too much, as long as they are the small and don't overlap(overdraw).

I need LOTS of decals in my game, is there performance best practice?

- make all decal cube as little/small as possible
- Make sure decal cube's face culling is disabled/closed.
- If your scene never goes into decal cube volume, you should set Cast to Lowload, and Cull to Back in the material inspector, doing this will improve GPU performance a lot! due to effective early Z. GPU only need to render decal's face.
- disable _ProjectionAngleDiscardSize, doing this will improve GPU performance a lot!
- enable "generate material" for your decal texture, else a high resolution decal texture will make your game size due to wide-mode in GPU memory.

If you do every optimization listed above, and your game is still slow due to the decal shader, please send me an issue, I will look at it asap.

Implementation Reference

Ivan Campeanu, High Fidelity: The Rendering of INSIDE's optimized decal shader

https://youtu.be/RdN6tIbbCBI?t=2170

Screen Space Decals in Warhammer 40,000: Space Marine

https://www.slideshare.net/blindsdesign/screen-space-decals-in-warhammer-40000-space-marine-14285547?from_search=0&qid=6d0ca4ca-5ca3-4f5a-a0ab-2f1a57f3a8ca&v=&b=&from_search=0 by Blindsdesign